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Charcoal from a hearth site in Colorado, 2,000 miles south of Alaska, is known to be 11,200 years old. Siberia is located in northeast Russia, and Alaska is located in northwest America. Researchers reasoned since glaciers prevented human migration south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge between 18,000 and 11,000 years ago, humans must have come to the Americas more than 18,000 years ago.

Which of the following pieces of new evidence would cast doubt on the conclusion drawn above?

A. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was determined the charcoal from the Colorado site was at least 11,400 years old.

B. Another campsite was found in New Mexico with remains dated at 16,000 years old.

C. A computer simulation of glacial activity showed it would already have been impossible for humans to travel south overland from Alaska 18,500 years ago.

D. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was proved that an ice-free corridor allowed passage south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge approximately 11,400 years ago.

E. Studies of various other hunting-gathering populations showed convincingly that once the glaciers allowed passage, humans could have migrated from Alaska to Colorado in about 20 years.

Argument Evaluation

Situation A hearth site in Colorado is 11,200 years old. Glaciers obstructed human migration from Siberia to Alaska, and therefore to the rest of North America, during a period lasting from 18,000 to 11,000 years ago, so researchers concluded human migration must have occurred before the glaciers blocked the land bridge—that is, before 18,000 years ago.

Reasoning *What would have made it possible for humans to migrate more recently?* The researchers' conclusion that humans must have come to North America prior to the obstruction caused by the glaciers 18,000 years ago is reasonable unless new evidence calls their premises into question. If, for example, evidence suggested the land bridge was open at any more recent date before the date of the hearth site, that would imply humans could have arrived later and therefore cast doubt on the researchers' conclusion.

A. If the hearth site is at least 11,400 years old, it would still fall in or prior to the interval when the land bridge was obstructed and therefore suggest humans must have arrived before the obstruction; therefore, that fact would not cast doubt on the conclusion.

B. A much earlier campsite would tend to support the researchers' conclusion, not cast doubt on it.

C. While this fact would imply an even earlier date of human migration, it would not cast doubt on the conclusion that such migration occurred *more than* 18,000 years ago.

D. **Correct**. Evidence of a corridor that allowed human migration 11,400 years ago—200 years before the date of the campsite—would cast doubt on the conclusion that humans necessarily must have arrived in North America much earlier.

E. The fact that hunter-gatherers could have made the journey to Colorado in twenty years has no bearing on whether they could have made that journey more recently than 18,000 years ago.

The correct answer is D.

•

A group of children of various ages was read stories in which people caused harm, with some of those people doing so intentionally, and some accidentally. When asked about appropriate punishments for those who had caused harm, the younger children, unlike the older ones, assigned punishments that did not vary according to whether the harm was done intentionally or accidentally. Younger children, then, do not regard people's intentions as relevant to punishment.

Which of the following, if true, would most seriously weaken the conclusion above?

A. In interpreting these stories, the listeners had to draw on a relatively mature sense of human psychology in order to tell whether harm was produced intentionally or accidentally.

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B. In these stories, the severity of the harm produced was clearly stated.

C. Younger children are as likely to produce harm unintentionally as older children.

D. The older children assigned punishment in a way that closely resembled the way adults had assigned punishment in a similar experiment.

E. The younger children assigned punishments that varied according to the severity of the harm done by the agents in the stories.

Argument Evaluation

Situation Children of mixed ages heard stories about people causing harm; in some cases the harm was caused deliberately, and in other cases it was caused accidentally. When the children were asked what punishments would be appropriate, younger children, unlike older ones, assigned equal punishments regardless of whether the harm was intentional. This leads to the conclusion that younger children do not think intentions should matter when determining punishment.

Reasoning *What would undermine support for the conclusion that young children regard intention as irrelevant?* If the younger children had difficulty discerning whether or not the harmful acts in the stories were intentional, that would weaken support for the conclusion that these children think intention should not matter.

A. **Correct.** If it required maturity to evaluate whether the harm caused was intentional or accidental, that fact might suggest the younger children simply could not make that determination, not that they believed intention should not affect punishment as the argument concludes.

B. The argument rests on children's understanding of the intention behind the harm, not on their understanding the severity of the harm itself.

C. The relative rates at which younger and older children accidentally cause harm are not relevant to the conclusion.

D. The similarity between older children's responses and those of adults has no bearing on the beliefs of younger children regarding the relationship between intentionality and guilt.

E. The fact that younger children took the severity of harm into account does not affect the conclusion that these children believed intention *should not* be taken into account.

The correct answer is A.

•

Mansour: We should both plan to change some of our investments from coal companies to less polluting energy companies, and here's why: Consumers are increasingly demanding nonpolluting energy, and energy companies are increasingly supplying it.

Therese: I'm not sure we should do what you suggest. As demand for nonpolluting energy increases relative to supply, its price will increase, and then the more polluting energy will cost relatively less. Demand for the cheaper, dirtier energy forms will then increase, as will the stock values of the companies that produce them.

Therese responds to Mansour's proposal by doing which of the following?

A. Advocating that consumers use less expensive forms of energy

B. Implying that not all uses of coal for energy are necessarily polluting

C. Disagreeing with Mansour's claim that consumers are increasingly demanding nonpolluting energy

D. Suggesting that leaving their existing energy investments unchanged could be the better course

E. Providing a reason to doubt Mansour's assumption that supply of nonpolluting energy will increase in line with demand

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Therese and Mansour are discussing what energy investments will be more profitable. Mansour claims the most profitable course is to move their investments from dirty to clean energy because consumer demand for clean energy is increasing. Therese counters with the claim that demand for

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consumer demand for clean energy is increasing. Therese counters with the claim that demand for clean energy will outstrip supply and thereby raise prices for such energy; that in turn will make dirty energy comparatively cheap, driving demand back in its direction and thereby making investments in dirty energy more profitable once again.

Reasoning *What function does Therese's argument perform?* Mansour argues they should switch to investing in clean energy as he believes it will be more profitable. Therese argues shifting demand will ultimately make dirty energy more profitable; this in turn implies keeping their investments in dirty energy will be the superior course.

A. Therese anticipates consumers will choose cheaper energy but does not advocate for such a choice.

B. Therese does not imply there are some uses of coal for energy that may not be polluting, only that investing in coal is likely to be profitable.

C. Therese does not dispute Mansour's claim that demand for clean energy is rising; rather, she anticipates rising demand will lead to rising prices.

D. **Correct.** Therese's argument suggests their current investments in dirty energy will ultimately become more profitable, and therefore it would be better not to switch to investing in clean energy.

E. Mansour may well assume the supply of clean energy will increase in line with demand, and Therese assumes supply *will not* meet demand, but she offers no evidence that her position is the correct one.

The correct answer is D.

•

The earliest Mayan pottery found at Colha in Belize is about 3,000 years old. Recently, however, 4,500-year-old stone agricultural implements were unearthed at Colha. These implements resemble Mayan stone implements of a much later period, also found at Colha. Moreover, the implements' designs are strikingly different from the designs of stone implements produced by other cultures known to have inhabited the area in prehistoric times. Therefore, there were surely Mayan settlements in Colha 4,500 years ago.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Ceramic ware is not known to have been used by the Mayans to make agricultural implements.

B. Carbon dating of corn pollen in Colha indicates agriculture began there around 4,500 years ago.

C. Archaeological evidence indicates some of the oldest stone implements found at Colha were used to cut away vegetation after controlled burning of trees to open areas of swampland for cultivation.

D. Successor cultures at a given site often adopt the style of agricultural implements used by earlier inhabitants of the same site.

E. Many religious and social institutions of the Mayan people who inhabited Colha 3,000 years ago relied on a highly developed system of agricultural symbols.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation Mayan pottery found at Colha dates back as far as 3,000 years. Stone agricultural implements at the same site date back 4,500 years. These implements are similar to later Mayan ones and dissimilar to implements from other cultures in the region. This leads to the conclusion that the Mayans *surely* lived in Colha 4,500 years ago.

Reasoning *What factor would suggest that the stone implements might not be Mayan?* The claim that the Mayans lived at Colha 4,500 years ago rests entirely on the fact that stone agricultural implements from that date and place resemble later Mayan implements and do not resemble those of other nearby cultures. Therefore, if some other explanation could account for that resemblance that would weaken the argument that the Mayans must have lived at Colha 4,500 years ago.

A. The agricultural implements under discussion are stone, not ceramic, so this point is irrelevant.

B. The date at which agriculture began at Colha has no bearing on whether or not those farmers were Mayan.

C. The purpose for which the stone implements were used does not suggest the users might not have been Mayan.

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C. The purpose for which the stone implements were used does not suggest the users might not have been Mayan.

D. **Correct.** If cultures often copy the agricultural implements of those who preceded them at the same location, that fact would suggest the possibility that the Mayans of 3,000 years ago could have copied implements made by a different, earlier culture at the site. This possibility would not disprove the hypothesis that the Colha farmers of 4,500 years ago were Mayan, but it would weaken the argument that they were *surely* Mayan.

E. The highly developed agricultural symbols used by the Mayans 3,000 years ago at Colha do not weaken the argument that the Mayans were *surely* already at Colha 4,500 years ago; if anything, they provide modest support for that argument by suggesting the Mayans probably had lived there for some time.

The correct answer is D.

Questions 739–802 — Difficulty: Hard

739. Duckbill dinosaurs, like today's monitor lizards, had particularly long tails, which they could whip at considerable speed. Monitor lizards use their tails to strike predators. However, although duckbill tails were otherwise very similar to those of monitor lizards, the duckbill's tailbones were proportionately much thinner and thus more delicate. Moreover, to ward off their proportionately much larger predators, duckbills would have had to whip their tails considerably faster than monitor lizards do.

The information given, if accurate, provides the strongest support for which of the following hypotheses?

A. If duckbills whipped their tails faster than monitor lizards do, the duckbill's tail would have been effective at warding off the duckbills' fiercest predators.

B. Duckbills used their tails to strike predators, and their tailbones were frequently damaged from the impact.

C. Using their tails was not the only means duckbills had for warding off predators.

D. Duckbills were at much greater risk of being killed by a predator than monitor lizards are.

E. The tails of duckbills, if used to ward off predators, would have been more likely than the tails of monitor lizards to sustain damage from the impact.

Argument Construction

Situation Duckbill dinosaur tails were like the tails of contemporary monitor lizards in that they were very long. They differed, though, in that their tailbones were much thinner and more delicate than monitor lizards' tailbones. Monitor lizards use their tails to strike predators. If duckbills did so, they would have had to whip their tails much faster, as their predators were proportionately much larger.

Reasoning *Which hypothesis is most strongly supported by the given information?* The information states that duckbills would have had to whip their tails much faster than monitor lizards do to ward off their proportionately larger predators, but their tailbones were more delicate. It would be reasonable to conclude, then, that duckbills' tails would have been more likely to sustain damage if used to ward off predators than monitor lizards' tails are.

A. The information gives us little reason to be confident that duckbills would have been effective at warding off their fiercest predators even if they whipped their tails faster than monitor lizards do. Note that we are not even told how effective monitor lizards are at warding off particularly fierce predators.

B. The information gives us both a reason to think that duckbills might have used their tails to strike predators—their tails are similar in length to the tails of monitor lizards, which are used to strike predators—and reasons to think they might not have done so—their tailbones were much thinner and more delicate than monitor lizards' tailbones, and they would have had to whip their tails much faster than monitor lizards whip theirs. Therefore, the support for this answer choice is not very strong.

C. The information does give some modest support for the claim that duckbills' tails would not provide a particularly good defense against their predators. This suggests weakly that they had other defenses against their predators. Note, though, that this answer choice, as worded, entails that duckbills *did* use their tails as a defense; it was simply not the only defense. But the information on which we are to base the hypothesis is compatible with duckbills not having used their tails to ward off predators.

D. The information does not give much support for this answer choice. It could be that duckbills had other effective defenses against their predators. Perhaps they were fast or had sharp claws.

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E. **Correct.** As noted above, duckbills would have had to whip their tails much faster than monitor lizards do to ward off their proportionately larger predators, but their tailbones were more delicate, so duckbills' tails would have been more likely to sustain damage if used to ward off predators than monitor lizards' tails are.

The correct answer is E.

740. In an attempt to produce a coffee plant that would yield beans containing no caffeine, the synthesis of a substance known to be integral to the initial stages of caffeine production was blocked either in the beans, in the leaves, or both. For those plants in which synthesis of the substance was blocked only in the leaves, the resulting beans contained no caffeine.

Any of the following, if true, would provide the basis for an explanation of the observed results EXCEPT:

A. In coffee plants, the substance is synthesized only in the leaves and then moves to the beans, where the initial stages of caffeine production take place.

B. In coffee plants, the last stage of caffeine production takes place in the beans using a compound that is produced only in the leaves by the substance.

C. In coffee plants, the initial stages of caffeine production take place only in the beans, but later stages depend on another substance that is synthesized only in the leaves and does not depend on the blocked substance.

D. In coffee plants, caffeine production takes place only in the leaves, but the caffeine then moves to the beans.

E. Caffeine was produced in the beans of the modified coffee plants, but all of it moved to the leaves, which normally produce their own caffeine.

Argument Evaluation

Situation The synthesis of a substance integral to the initial production of caffeine was blocked only in the beans of some coffee plants, only in the leaves of others, and in both the beans and leaves of yet other coffee plants. No caffeine was found in beans from the plants in which the synthesis of the substance was blocked only in the leaves.

Reasoning *Which claim would NOT form the basis for an explanation of the observed results?* There are many possible explanations. For instance, the results could be explained by any claim that indicates (1) that the substance integral to the initial production of caffeine is synthesized only in the leaves, or (2) that the substance is also produced in the beans but, when it is blocked from being produced in the leaves, that substance or the caffeine that is produced in the beans is entirely depleted from the beans. However, the observed results would *not* be explained by any claim that (1) indicates that the early stages of caffeine synthesis can occur in the beans, entailing that the crucial substance is present in the beans even when it is blocked in the leaves, and (2) provides no explanation for why blocking the crucial substance in the leaves would prevent the completion of the caffeine synthesis in the beans.

A. If a substance that is integral to the initial production of caffeine is produced only in the leaves, and that production has been blocked, then the observed results are to be expected.

B. If the last stage of caffeine production requires a compound that is produced in the leaves by a substance the synthesis of which is blocked in the leaves, then the observed results are to be expected.

C. **Correct.** Suppose the initial stages of caffeine production take place in the beans. The substance integral to those initial stages must therefore be present in the beans. But this does not tell us whether that substance is synthesized in the beans or elsewhere. It does tell us that some other substance that plays a part in the production of caffeine is synthesized in the leaves, but we are not told that the synthesis of that substance is blocked. Therefore, this answer choice does not give us reason to expect the observed results, and so does not serve as the basis for an explanation of those results.

D. Suppose we know that caffeine production in coffee plants takes place entirely in the leaves but at least some of the caffeine migrates from there to the beans. Then, if the synthesis of a substance that is integral to the initial production of caffeine is blocked in the leaves, it seems reasonable to expect the observed results.

E. If caffeine is normally produced in both the leaves and the beans of a coffee plant, but all the caffeine produced in the beans will migrate from the beans to the leaves if for any reason caffeine is not produced in

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produced in the beans will migrate from the beans to the leaves if for any reason caffeine is not produced in the leaves, then it is reasonable to expect the observed results.

The correct answer is C.

741. Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

Laminated glass is much harder to break than the glass typically used in the windows of cars driven in Relnia. It is more difficult for thieves to break into cars with laminated glass windows than into cars with ordinary glass windows, and laminated glass windows are less likely to break in a collision. Nevertheless, considerations of security and safety do not unambiguously support a proposal to require that in Relnia all glass installed in cars be laminated glass, since _____.

A. most people cannot visually distinguish laminated glass from the glass typically used for car windows

B. a significant proportion of cars driven in Relnia are manufactured elsewhere

C. some cars in Relnia already have laminated glass in their windows

D. the rates of car theft and of collisions have both fallen slightly in Relnia in recent years

E. there are times when breaking a car's window is the best way to provide timely help for people trapped inside

Argument Construction

Situation Laminated glass is much more difficult to break than the glass that is typically used in car windows in Relnia and, when used in a car window, makes it harder for thieves to break into the car and is less likely to shatter in collisions.

Reasoning *What claim, despite the given information, most helps support the conclusion that considerations of security and safety do not unambiguously support a proposal to require that in Relnia all glass installed in cars be laminated glass?* If there are any significant safety or security problems that would arise from having laminated glass, this would count against the proposal. For instance, sometimes it is essential to break a car's window to help people trapped in the car.

A. None of the security- or safety-related characteristics of laminated glass discussed in the argument depend on laminated glass being visually distinguishable from the glass typically used for car windows. Therefore, this answer choice does not help justify the conclusion and so would not logically complete the passage.

B. Even if most cars in Relnia are manufactured elsewhere, there may be no reason not to require that all glass installed in cars in Relnia be laminated glass.

C. Whether some cars, no cars, or all cars currently in Relnia have laminated glass in their windows is irrelevant to whether it is a good idea to require that all glass installed in cars in Relnia be laminated glass.

D. Even if rates of car theft and of collision have fallen, that does not mean they could not fall further if laminated glass were required. In fact, we are not told why they fell. Could it be that more cars in Relnia had windows made of laminated glass, and that this led to these reduced rates?

E. **Correct.** This answer choice provides a reason to think that sometimes, for the security or safety of passengers in cars, it might be better not to have all the windows of every car made of laminated glass. Therefore, it logically completes the passage.

The correct answer is E.

742. Consultant: **Ace Repairs ends up having to redo a significant number of the complex repair jobs it undertakes, but when those repairs are redone, they are invariably done right.** Since we have established that there is no systematic difference between the mechanics who are assigned to do the initial repairs and those who are assigned to redo unsatisfactory jobs, we must reject the hypothesis that mistakes made in the initial repairs are due to the mechanics' lack of competence. Rather, it is likely that **complex repairs require a level of focused attention that the company's mechanics apply consistently only to repair jobs that have not been done right on the first try.**

In the consultant's reasoning, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is the consultant's main conclusion; the second provides evidence in support of that main conclusion.

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B. The first is evidence that serves as the basis for rejecting one explanation of a certain finding; the second is the consultant's own explanation of that finding.

C. The first is a claim whose truth is at issue in the reasoning; the second provides evidence to show that the claim is true.

D. The first presents a contrast whose explanation is at issue in the reasoning; the second is the consultant's explanation of that contrast.

E. The first presents a contrast whose explanation is at issue in the reasoning; the second is evidence that has been used to challenge the consultant's explanation of that contrast.

Argument Construction

Situation The following information is attributed to a consultant: Some complex repair jobs done by Ace Repairs have to be redone. The repairs, when redone, are usually successful. But the mechanics who do the initial repairs and any others who redo those repairs are, overall, competent to do the repairs successfully.

Reasoning *What role in the consultant's reasoning do the* ***boldfaced*** *statements play?* The consultant's first sentence describes a phenomenon that could be puzzling and needs explanation. One might be inclined to argue that the mechanics who redo the repairs are more competent than those who did the initial repairs. But the second **boldfaced** statement rebuts this explanation by telling us that it has been *established* that there are no systematic differences in competence. The final sentence of the consultant's reasoning puts forward another explanation: that the redoing of a repair elicits from mechanics a higher level of focused attention than did the performance of the initial repair.

A. The first describes a puzzling phenomenon for which the consultant seeks an explanation. It is not presented as a conclusion, i.e., a statement that is asserted on the basis of other statements. The second is not a statement presented *in support of* the first; it gives an explanation offered by the consultant for the puzzling phenomenon described in the first **boldfaced** portion.

B. The first describes a puzzling phenomenon for which the consultant seeks an explanation, and it is not offered to show that a certain explanation does not fit. The second gives the consultant's own explanation of that finding.

C. The reasoning does not question the accuracy of the first **boldfaced** portion; that portion is a description of a phenomenon that the consultant believes needs explanation. The second is not meant as evidence to indicate that the first is true; rather, it is offered as an explanation for the puzzling phenomenon described in the first.

D. **Correct.** The first **boldfaced** portion contrasts the success of repairs that are redone with the failure of those repairs when they were first done. The second gives an explanation proposed by the consultant for the difference.

E. The first contrasts the success of repairs that are redone with the failure of those repairs when they were first done. Rather than giving evidence to challenge the consultant's explanation, the second provides that explanation itself.

The correct answer is D.

743. To reduce waste of raw materials, the government of Sperland is considering requiring household appliances to be broken down for salvage when discarded. To cover the cost of salvage, the government is planning to charge a fee, which would be imposed when the appliance is first sold. Imposing the fee at the time of salvage would reduce waste more effectively, however, because consumers tend to keep old appliances longer if they are faced with a fee for discarding them.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Increasing the cost of disposing of an appliance properly increases the incentive to dispose of it improperly.

B. The fee provides manufacturers with no incentive to produce appliances that are more durable.

C. For people who have bought new appliances recently, the salvage fee would not need to be paid for a number of years.

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D. People who sell their used, working appliances to others would not need to pay the salvage fee.

E. Many nonfunctioning appliances that are currently discarded could be repaired at relatively little expense.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation A government is considering requiring household appliances to be broken down for salvage when discarded. To cover the salvage costs, the government plans to charge a fee on appliance sales.

Reasoning *What would suggest that charging the fee at the time of salvage would less effectively reduce waste than charging the fee at the time of sale would?* The argument is that charging the fee at the time of salvage would reduce waste of raw materials because it would encourage consumers to keep their appliances longer before salvaging them. This argument could be weakened by pointing out other factors that might increase waste if the fee is charged at the time of salvage or reduce waste if the fee is charged at the time of sale.

A. **Correct.** This suggests that charging the fee at the time of salvage rather than the time of sale would encourage consumers to discard their appliances illegally, thereby increasing waste of raw materials by reducing the proportion of discarded appliances that are salvaged.

B. This factor would remain the same regardless of whether the fee was charged at the time of sale or the time of salvage.

C. This might be a reason for consumers to prefer the fee be charged at the time of salvage rather than the time of sale, but it does not suggest that charging the fee at the time of salvage would reduce waste less effectively.

D. This provides an additional reason to expect that charging the fee at the time of salvage would help reduce waste, so it strengthens rather than weakens the argument.

E. This would give consumers an additional reason to keep using their old appliances and postpone paying a fee at the time of salvage, so it strengthens rather than weakens the argument.

The correct answer is A.

744. Twelve years ago and again five years ago, there were extended periods when the Changir Republic's currency, the pundra, was weak: Its value was unusually low relative to the world's most stable currencies. Both times, a weak pundra made Changir's manufactured products a bargain on world markets, and Changir's exports were up substantially. Now some politicians are saying in order to cause another similarly sized increase in exports, the government should allow the pundra to become weak again.

Which of the following, if true, provides the government with the strongest grounds to doubt that if followed, the politicians' recommendation will achieve its aim?

A. Several of the politicians now recommending the pundra be allowed to become weak made that same recommendation before each of the last two periods of currency weakness.

B. After several decades of operating well below peak capacity, Changir's manufacturing sector is now operating at near-peak levels.

C. The economy of a country experiencing a rise in exports will become healthier only if the country's currency is strong or the rise in exports is significant.

D. Those countries with manufactured products competing with Changir's on the world market all currently have stable currencies.

E. A sharp improvement in the efficiency of Changir's manufacturing plants would make Changir's products a bargain in world markets even without any weakening of the pundra relative to other currencies.

Argument Construction

Situation During two periods within the past two decades, the weakness of Changir's currency, the pundra, caused its exported goods to become more affordable in other countries; this affordability led to increased demand and increased exports. Politicians propose deliberately weakening the pundra to create a new surge in exports.

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Reasoning *What would prevent a weakened pundra from increasing exports?* The causal relationship between a weak pundra and surging exports would be likely to persist unless some additional factor inhibited an increase in exports from Changir. The existence of such a factor would therefore cast doubt on the plan's success.

A. The fact that particular politicians who recommended a successful plan in the past are again recommending the same plan—to increase exports by weakening the nation's currency—does not suggest the plan is unlikely to succeed in this case.

B. **Correct.** This factor would cast doubt on the plan's success. A weak pundra can lead to a surge in exports only if Changir's manufacturing sector has the capacity to meet a surge in demand. During the past two surges in exporting, that spare capacity existed since the option specifies manufacturing was below capacity for several decades. If, however, manufacturing is currently near capacity, the manufacturing sector will be unable to make substantially more goods for export even if a weakened pundra creates demand for those goods.

C. Because the plan only concerns increasing exports by weakening the currency, the possible impact of that plan on the overall economy is not relevant to the question of whether or not the plan is likely to succeed.

D. The stability of competing countries' currencies would not reduce the likelihood that a weaker pundra would increase demand for Changir's exports.

E. The fact that an alternative strategy *could* be employed for making Changir's products a bargain on the world market does not make it less likely that the strategy of making those products an attractive bargain by weakening the pundra would succeed.

The correct answer is B.

745.

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